# Classroom Experiments

Student guide: building, running and reviewing your group's experiment

Your group designs a small randomized experiment as a survey, runs it on your classmates in class, gives feedback on other groups' experiments, and analyzes your own results. Everything happens on one site, on a laptop or a phone.

1. **Sign in** with the classroom code, the classroom password and your student ID.
2. **Form your group and build your survey.** One person creates it and invites the rest.
3. **Optional extras**, only if your design needs them: optional questions, shuffled options, attention checks, an intro screen, follow-up questions, timers, a second part answered later, notifications.
4. **Preview it** as a respondent and as the results screen, and fix any warnings.
5. **Your instructor locks all surveys** before class. You can still preview and download.
6. **Class day:** answer every other group's survey on your phone while each group presents, in the presentation order.
7. **Give feedback** to the groups you're assigned, plus any others you like.
8. **Download your responses** (anonymized) and analyze them.

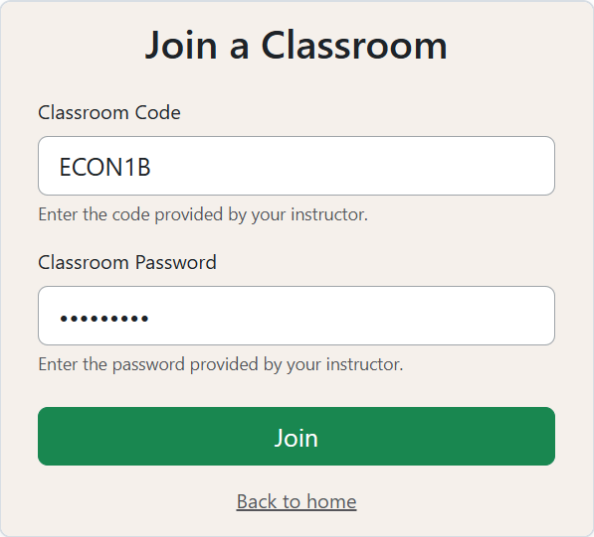
**Contents:**


1. Joining and signing in
2. Your lobby
3. Forming your group
4. Designing your survey
5. Question rules, survey options and earlier answers
6. Two-part surveys (optional)
7. Notifications (optional)
8. Running your survey on another platform
9. Previewing before class
10. Presentation order
11. Class day
12. Peer feedback
13. Downloading your data
14. Troubleshooting

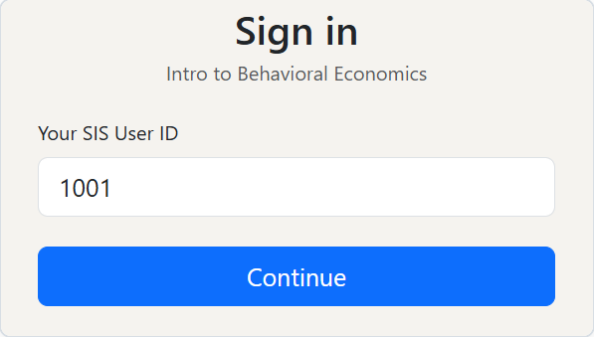
## 1. Joining and signing in

You sign in with your SIS User ID and a password you choose the first time. Your name comes from the class roster, so there's nothing to type and no typos in the data used for grading.

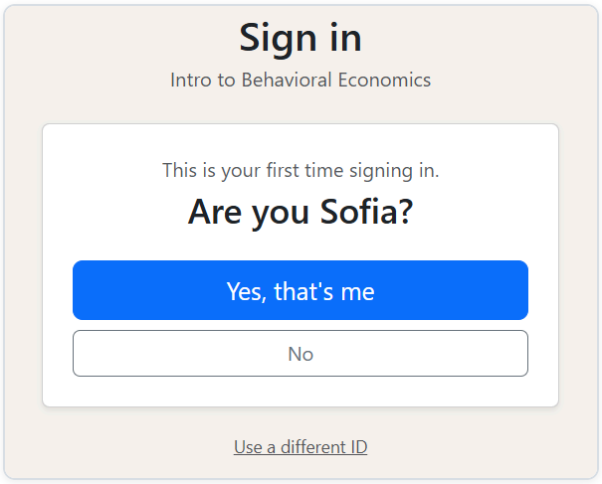
1. Go to the site and click **Join Classroom**, or scan the QR code shown in class. Enter the **classroom code** and the **classroom password** your instructor gave you, then click **Join**.



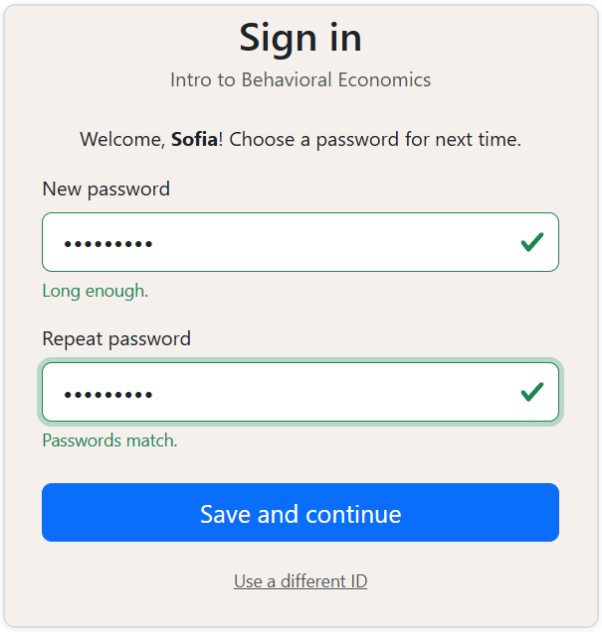

2. Enter your **SIS User ID** and click **Continue**.



3 The first time, the site asks **"Are you [your first name]?"** Click **Yes, that's me**. If it shows someone else's name, click **No** and check your ID. Never sign in as a classmate.




4 Choose a password (at least 6 characters) and type it twice. A green check shows when both match. Click **Save and continue**. Next time, you sign in with your SIS User ID and this password.




> **"ID not found"?** Check your ID and try again. If it still fails, email your instructor: you may not be on the roster yet.

## 2. Your lobby

After signing in you land in your lobby. Everything you need is there, and sections appear only when they're relevant. The first time you visit, a short guided tour points out each part; click **Show me around** at the top to see it again (the survey page has one too). Click a section's title to fold it away; your browser remembers which ones you folded.

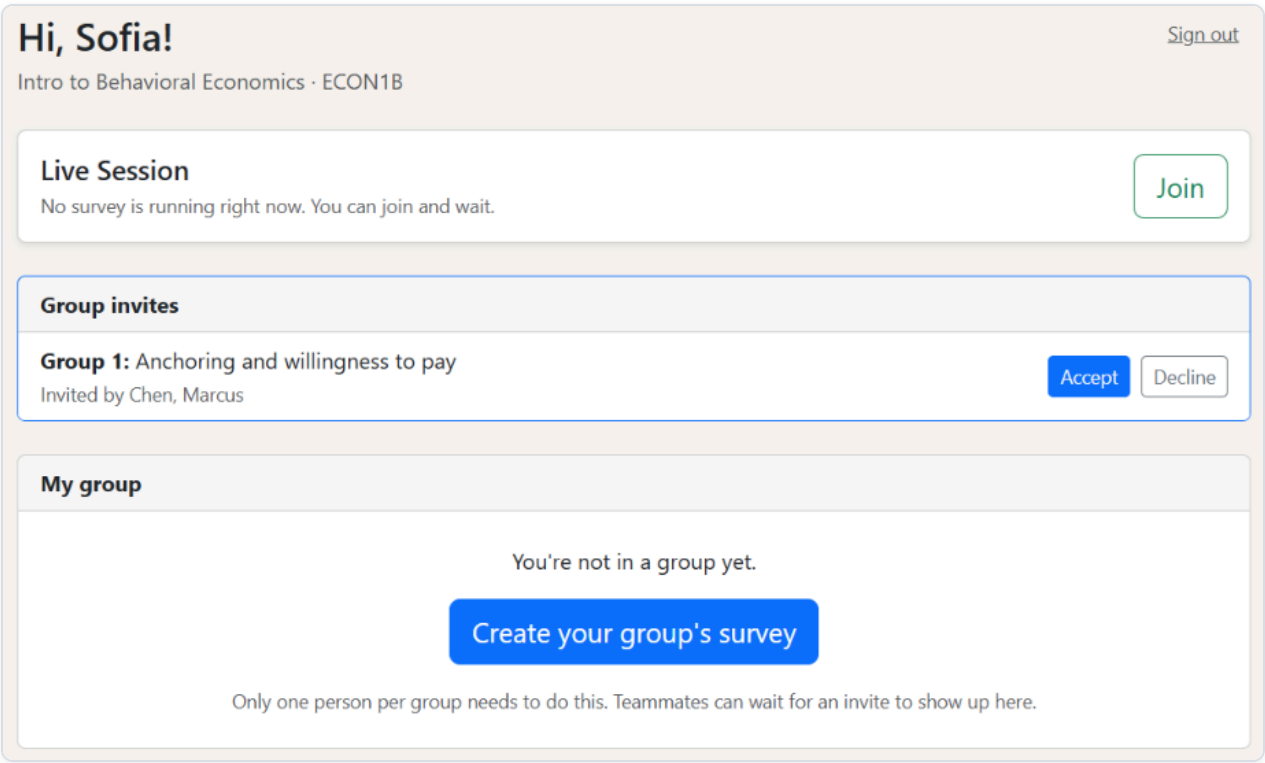
| Section | What it's for |
|---|---|
| Live Session | Join the surveys run in class. It shows **LIVE** in green when a survey is running. |
| Group invites | Invites from classmates to join their group. Accept or decline. |
| Open surveys | Surveys a group was allowed to run early. Answer them before their deadline. |
| Surveys to answer from here, and notifications | Parts of two-part surveys that you answer on your own time, and the notifications of surveys you answered. |
| My group | Your group's survey: members, status, warnings, number of responses and the data download. |
| Group finder | For finding teammates: classmates without a group who chose to be listed. |
| Presentation order | Every group's survey, in the order they run and present in class (once your instructor shows it). |
| Feedback for other groups | The groups you must comment on (they appear once surveys are locked), and your comments. |

## 3. Forming your group

Only one person per group creates the group; everyone else waits for an invite. You don't need to have the survey ready: form the group first, then build the survey together. Each student can be in one group, and a group can have at most 5 members (unless your instructor says otherwise).

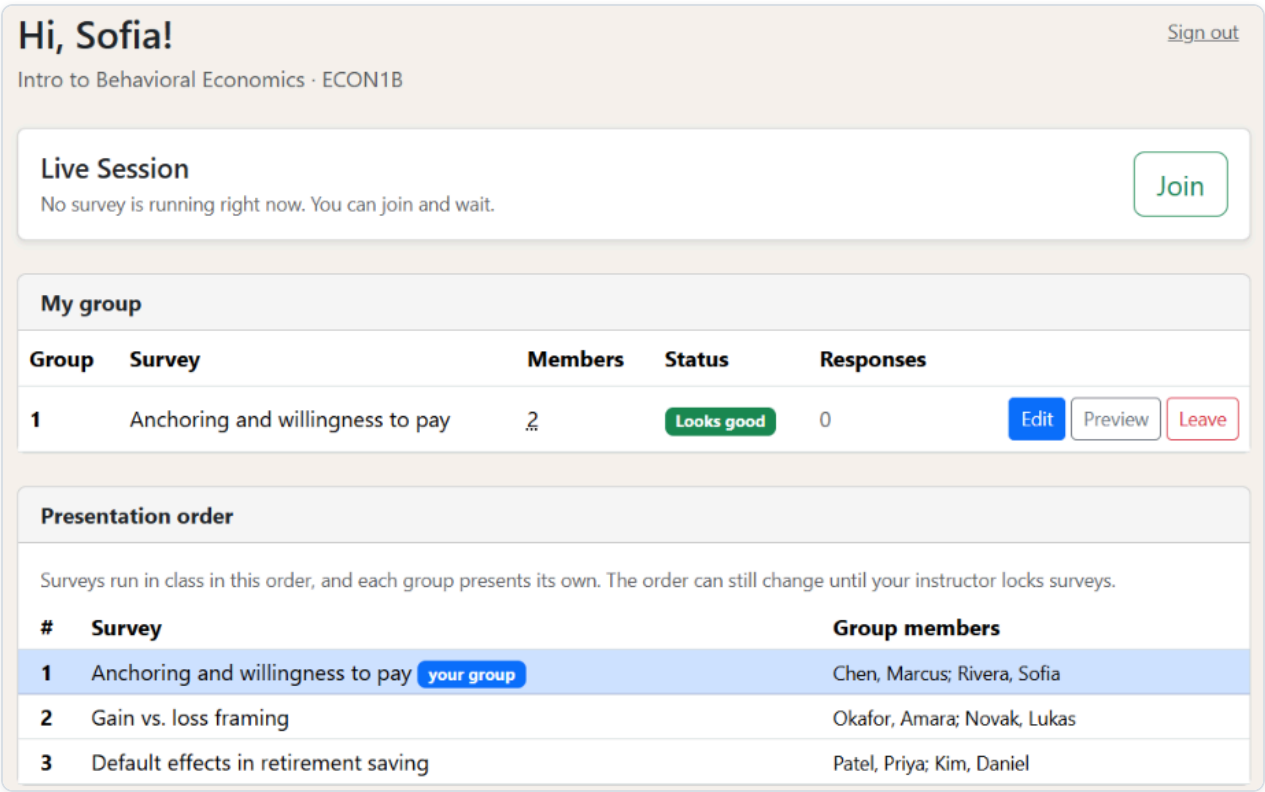
1. **One member** clicks **Create your group** in the lobby, types a title (optional) and, under **Teammates**, starts typing each classmate's name, picks it from the list and clicks **Add**. Then **Create group & start building**. They're added to the group automatically, and the group gets its number automatically. The number identifies your group; it isn't necessarily your place in the presentation order, which your instructor sets.
2. This opens your survey page. More invites can be sent any time from its **Group Members** card, at the top.

3 **The other members** accept the invite in their lobby, under **Group invites**.



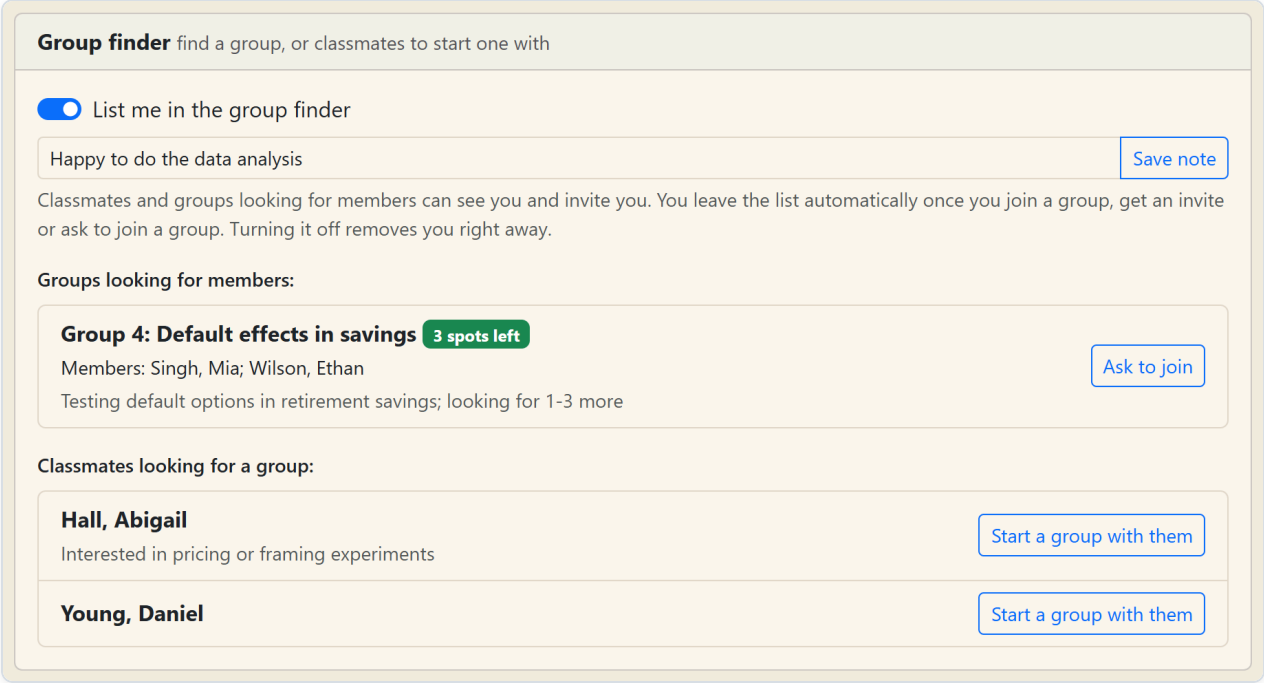

A new student's lobby: an invite from a classmate, or the button to create your own group.

Once you accept, your group appears under **My group**:



**Still looking for a group, or for teammates?** Use the **Group finder** in your lobby.

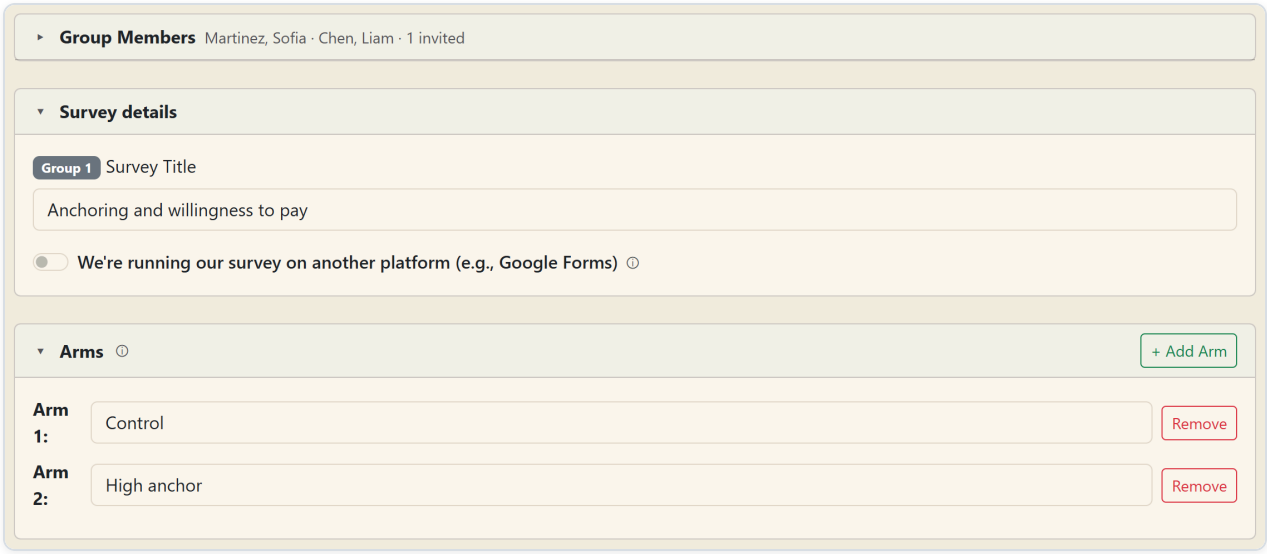
- **No group yet:** turn on **List me in the group finder** (optionally with a short note about the topics you like). You see **groups looking for members**, with their members and open spots: click **Ask to join** (one request at a time; you can withdraw it). You also see **classmates looking for a group**: **Start a group with them** creates a group and invites that person.
- **In a group with room:** turn on **List Group N as looking for members** (with an optional note). Requests to join show up in your lobby and on your survey page; **any member can accept**. You can also invite listed classmates directly.
- **Two small groups can merge:** a group with room sees the other listed groups and can click **Propose merging**. If any member of the other group accepts, all of your members move to their group and **your own survey is deleted** (download or copy anything you want to keep first). It only works if everyone fits within the group size limit, and not once your survey has responses.
- Students leave the list once they join a group, get an invite or ask to join one; a group leaves it once it's full. Only those who choose to be listed appear.
- Classmates may not check the site often: you can see their names, so message them on Canvas too.




> **"You can't accept this"?** Either that group is already full, or you're already in another group. In the second case, click **Leave** next to your current group in your lobby first. The last member of a group can't leave; invite someone first or delete the survey. Once your instructor freezes groups, you can keep editing your survey, but only your instructor can change groups: email them if you still need a group or want to switch.

## 4. Designing your survey

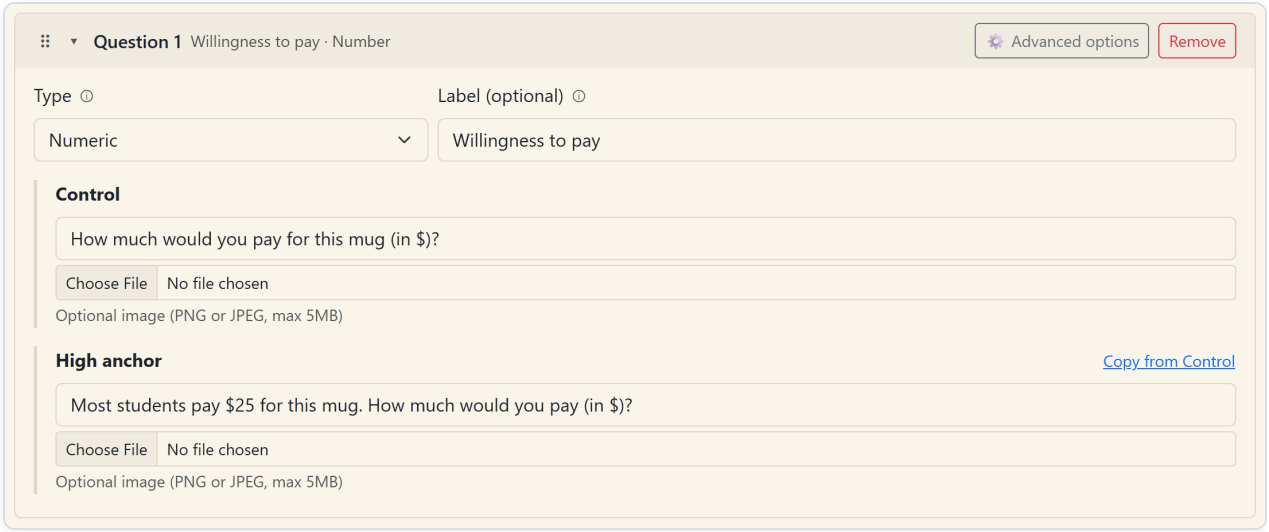
A survey is one experiment: each respondent is randomly shown one **arm** (control or a treatment), and the arms differ only in what you want to test. The survey page is made of cards (Group Members, Survey details, Arms, Questions, and two optional ones at the bottom). Click a card's title, or a question's, to fold it away; the ⓘ icons explain each setting.




1. **Arms (up to 4).** Name them, for example "Control" and "High anchor". Each respondent sees exactly one arm, and always the same one.

2. **Questions.** Every arm has the same questions, but the wording, image and answer options can differ per arm. That difference is your treatment. Your instructor sets a maximum number of questions (shown next to **Questions**); short surveys get better answers.

3. **Copy from Control.** Each arm after the first has this link. It copies the first arm's text, options and image, so you only change the part that differs.



4. **Folded questions** show a one-line summary with colored badges for any extras (only in some arms, follow-up, timer, "Other", part 2). **Drag a question by its ⠿ handle** to move it up or down: no need to delete and retype.




5. **Images** (PNG or JPEG, up to 5 MB) are optional, per arm and question. **+ Add "Other"** adds an "Other" choice with a text box to a multiple-choice question.

6. **Warnings.** The page warns you if two arms are identical in every question, which means there's no treatment.

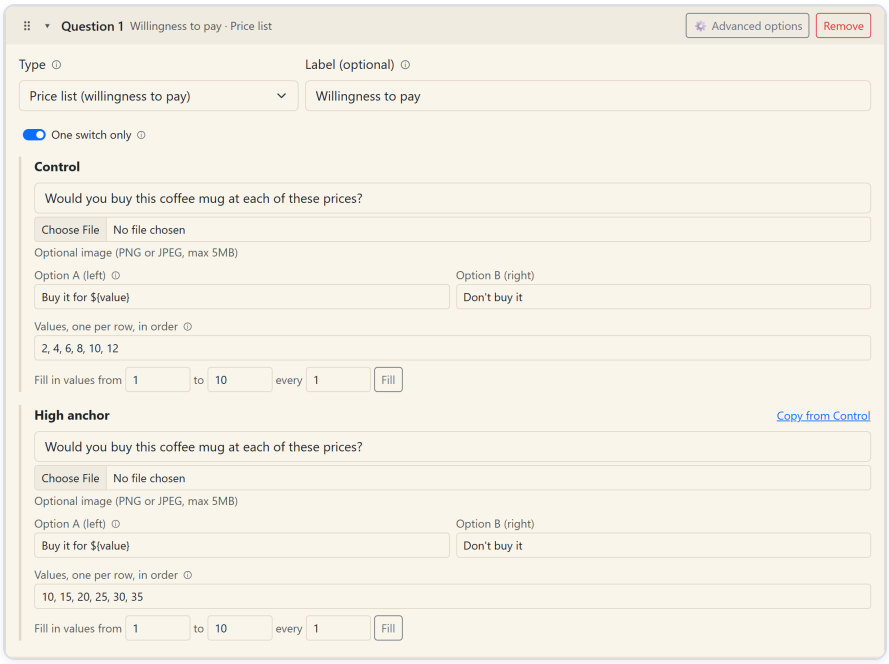
### Question types

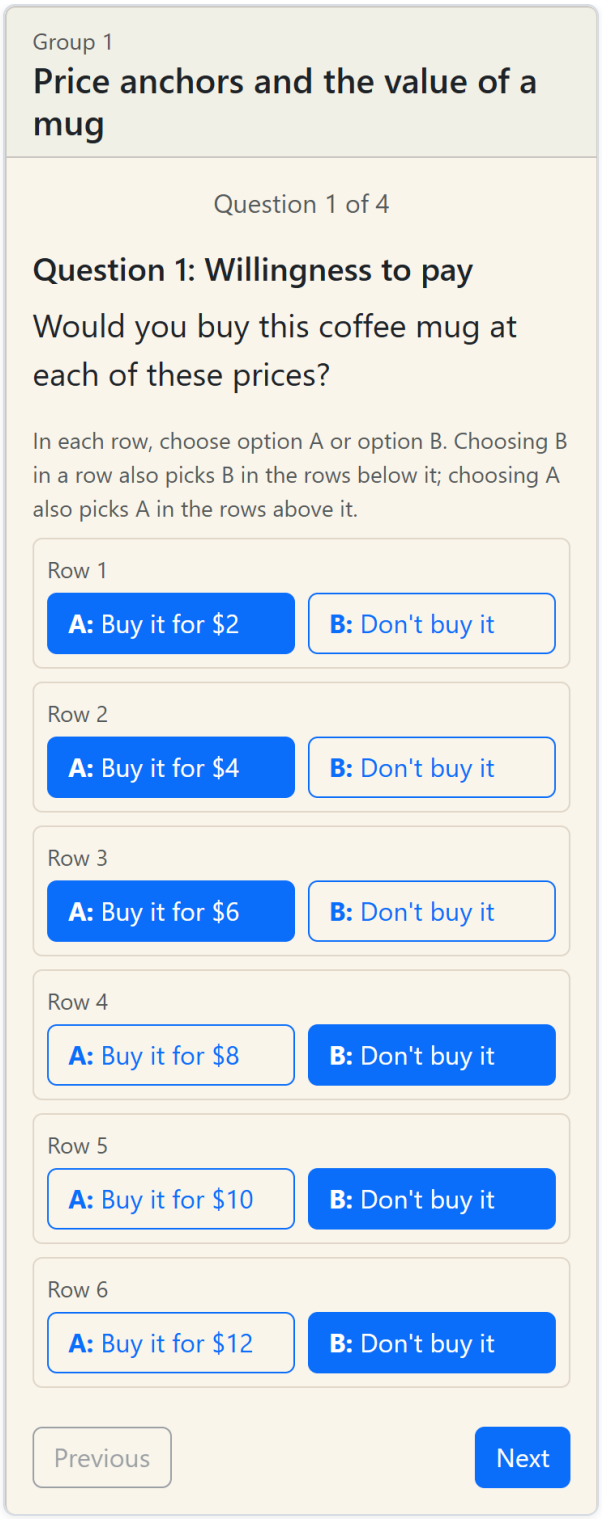
The **Type** menu lists the most common types first. Pick the simplest type that measures what you need: simple questions get more careful answers, especially on a phone.

| Question type | Respondents see | Results show | Good for |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Basic** | | | |
| Multiple choice | buttons, pick one | bar chart by arm | most questions; up to 5 options, plus "Other" |
| Multiple answer | buttons, pick several | bar chart by arm | "select all that apply" |
| Number | a number box (optional limits) | histogram and mean, median, SD | estimates, counts, amounts |
| Short answer | a text box (140 characters) | the answers by arm, identical ones grouped | open reactions; hard to compare across arms |
| Slider | a slider with your min, max and step | histogram and statistics | continuous ratings, percentages |
| **Rankings and scales** | | | |
| Ranking | tap the items in order of preference | average rank of each item; most often ranked first | priorities; keep it to 3 to 6 items |
| Rating scale | one point on a labeled scale (e.g. 1 to 5) | count per point; mean, median | attitudes (agree/disagree, likely/unlikely) |
| Rating grid | several statements, each rated on the same scale | average rating of each statement | a short set of related attitudes; a few rows only |
| Picture choice | pictures to tap, pick one | bar chart by arm | products, designs, labels |
| **Economics** | | | |
| Budget split | amounts for each item that must add up to a total (e.g. 100) | average amount per item | allocations, trade-offs |
| Price list | option A or B in each row, at increasing prices | % choosing A at each price (a demand curve) | willingness to pay |
| Lottery choices | a safer or riskier lottery in each row (Holt and Laury) | % choosing the safe option per row | risk attitude |

- **Rating scales:** choose the number of points (5 or 7 are most common) and label at least both ends; **Fill labels in every arm** fills in standard wording (agree, likely, satisfied...). Labeling every point gives more consistent answers.
- **Picture choice:** upload one picture per choice (2 to 8). Captions are optional; without one the answer is recorded as "Picture 1", "Picture 2"...
- **Price list:** write option A with `{value}` where the price goes (e.g. `Buy it for ${value}`), option B, and the values, one per row. **Fill in values** makes a range for you. The values can differ between arms: the range itself can be your treatment. With **One switch only** (recommended), choosing B in a row also picks B in every row below it, so each respondent switches at most once.

- **Lottery choices:** starts with the classic amounts ($2.00 / $1.60 against $3.85 / $0.10, 10 rows); row *k* gives a *k*-in-10 chance of the high amount. The number of safe (A) choices measures risk aversion.


Question 1 Willingness to pay · Price list
Advanced options
Remove
Type
Price list (willingness to pay)
Label (optional)
Willingness to pay
One switch only
Control
Would you buy this coffee mug at each of these prices?
Choose File
No file chosen
Optional image (PNG or JPEG, max 5MB)
Option A (left)
Buy it for ${value}
Option B (right)
Don't buy it
Values, one per row, in order
2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12
Fill in values from 1 to 10 every 1 Fill
High anchor
Copy from Control
Would you buy this coffee mug at each of these prices?
Choose File
No file chosen
Optional image (PNG or JPEG, max 5MB)
Option A (left)
Buy it for ${value}
Option B (right)
Don't buy it
Values, one per row, in order
10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35
Fill in values from 1 to 10 every 1 Fill




The same price list on a phone: this respondent would buy at $6 but not at $8.

Group 1

## Price anchors and the value of a mug

Question 2 of 4

**Question 2: Liking**

How much do you like the design of this mug?

1 Not at all

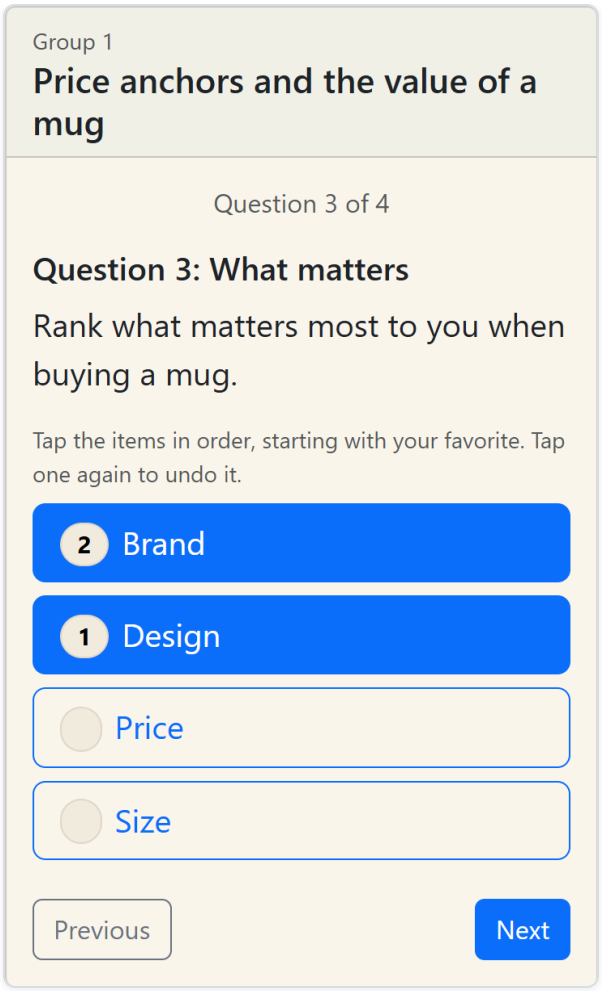
2 Slightly

3 Moderately

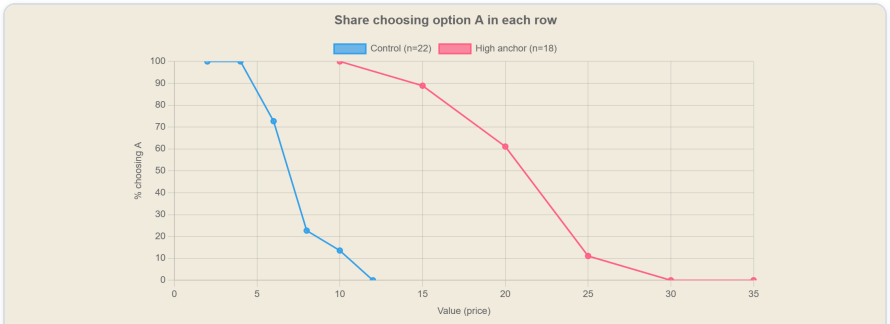
4 Very much

5 Extremely

Previous Next




A rating scale and a ranking question on a phone.




| Arm | N | Mean A choices | Switched more than once |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Control** | 22 | 3.09 | 0 |
| **High anchor** | 18 | 2.61 | 0 |

Price list results on the dashboard: the share buying at each price, one curve per arm.

**Example.** To test anchoring: two arms, one numeric question. Control asks "How much would you pay for this mug?" The "High anchor" arm asks "Most students pay $25 for this mug. How much would you pay?"

**Saving.** Your edits save automatically, even when the survey isn't finished: the bar at the top says when. A blue **Not finished yet** box lists what's still missing (for example "Question 1, Treatment: write the question"), and your lobby shows **Not finished** until it's complete. **Discard all changes from this session** puts the

survey back the way it was when you opened it in that tab. Teammates editing at the same time overwrite each other, so take turns.

**Getting around.** Use **My lobby** in the top bar (or the "← My lobby" link) to go back, and **Sign out** when you're done on a shared computer.

**Group members.** The top of the survey page lists your group and lets you invite more classmates.

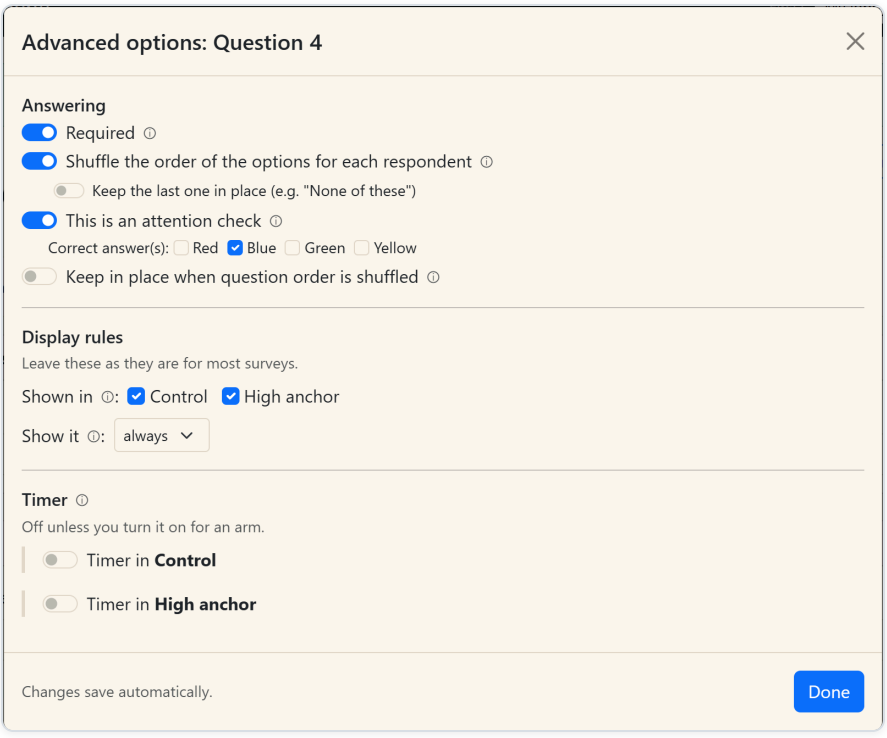



---

## 5. Question rules, survey options and earlier answers

Most surveys don't need any of this. Each question has an ⚙ **Advanced options** button that opens:

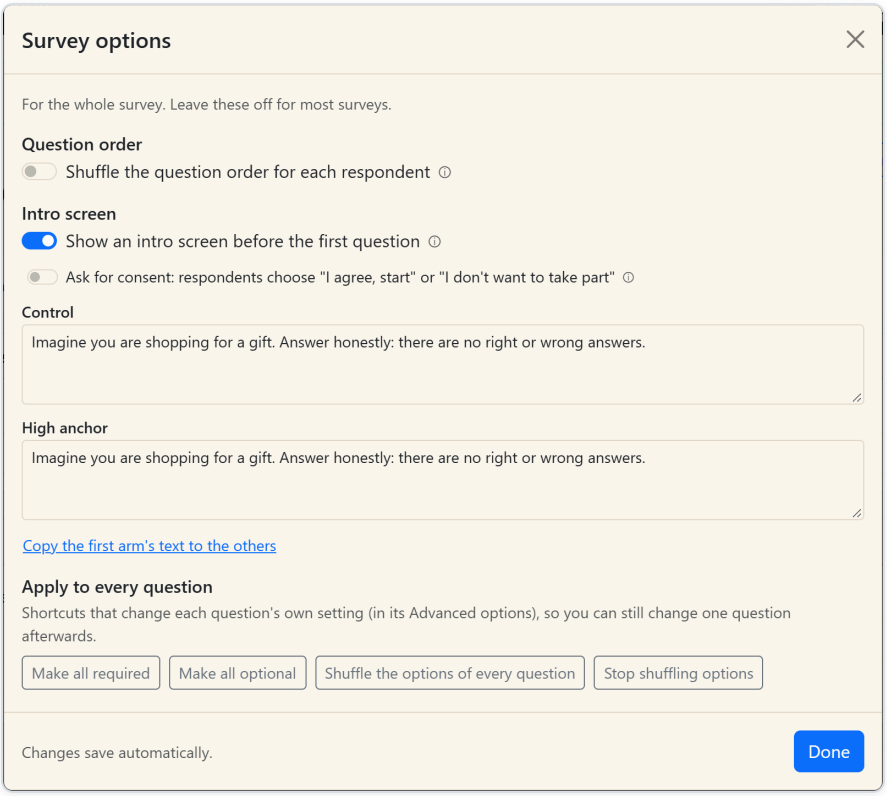
- **Required** (on by default): respondents must answer before moving on. Turn it off to let them skip the question; they then see "Optional" and a **Clear answer** link, and the data shows a blank. In an experiment, keep the outcome questions required.
- **Shuffle the order of the options** (choice, ranking, picture, budget and grid questions): each respondent sees them in their own random order, so the first option isn't favored just for being first. **Keep the last one in place** is for options like "None of these". The data records the order each respondent saw.
- **Smallest / largest allowed** and **whole numbers only** (number questions): answers outside the limits are refused with a message.
- **This is an attention check** (choice, picture and rating questions): a question with an obvious right answer, e.g. "To show you are reading, choose Blue". Tick the correct answer. The dashboard shows how many passed, and the data has a "passed check" column. Nobody is removed automatically: decide before class what you'll do with those who fail.
- **Keep in place when question order is shuffled**: see Survey options below.
- **Shown in**: untick an arm to ask the question only in the other arms (its version in the unticked arm is greyed out).
- **Show it: only if Question N is …**: a follow-up, shown only to respondents who picked certain answers to an earlier multiple-choice question. Everyone else skips it.
- **Timer**, per arm: a time limit in seconds (up to 600), shown as a countdown, a shrinking bar, both, or hidden; and the answer recorded if time runs out (or none). The data marks timed-out answers.



### Survey options

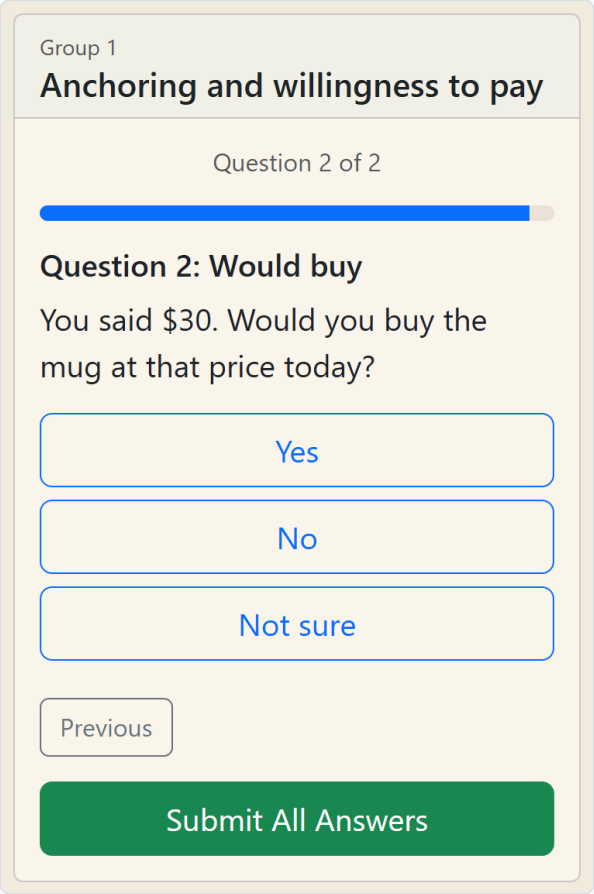
The ⚙ **Survey options** button on the Questions card has settings for the whole survey:

- **Shuffle the question order for each respondent**, to rule out order effects. Follow-up questions, questions that use an earlier answer ( `{{Q1}}` ), and any question you mark **Keep in place** stay where they are. The data records where each question was shown.
- **Intro screen**: a text respondents read before the first question, with a Start button (instructions or a scenario). It can differ between arms. **Ask for consent** shows "I agree, start" and "I don't want to take part"; nothing is recorded for those who decline.
- **Apply to every question**: shortcuts to make every question required or optional, or to shuffle every question's options. They change each question's own setting, so you can still change one question afterwards.




### Putting an earlier answer into a later question

Type `{{Q1}}` in a question's text to show the respondent's answer to Question 1 there ( `{{Q2}}` for Question 2, and so on; upper or lower case both work). For example, Question 2's text `You said ${{Q1}}. Would you buy the mug at that price today?` appears to someone who answered 30 as:

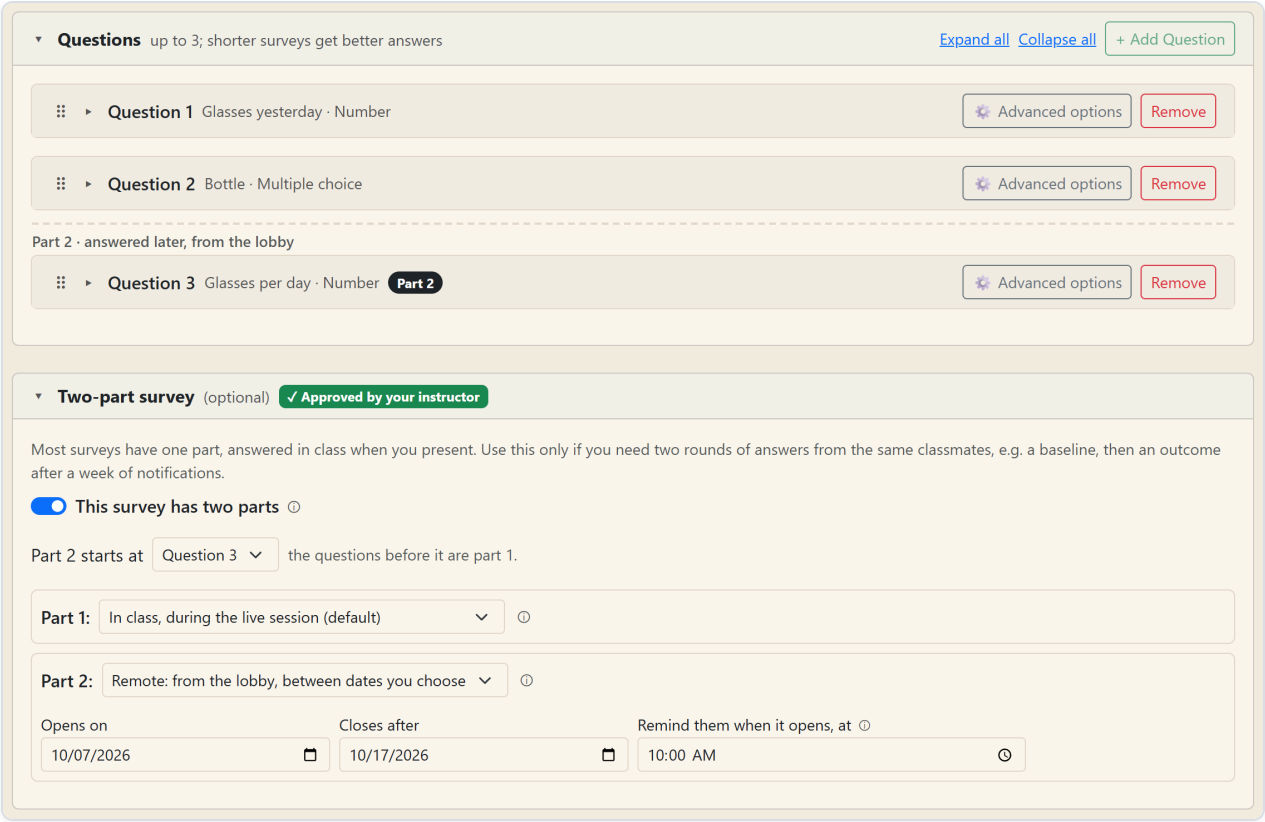



> **Rules for {{Qn}}:** the number is the question's number on your survey page, it must be an earlier question, and that question must be answered in the same sitting (in a two-part survey, both questions in the same part). If the earlier question was skipped (a follow-up the respondent didn't get), they see the text `{{Q1}}` itself, so only use answers everyone in that arm gives; an optional question they chose to skip shows "(no answer)". Rankings show the items in order, rating scales show the point's label. Multiple-answer questions show the choices separated by commas, and "Other" shows what the respondent typed. Check it with **Preview survey**.

---

## 6. Two-part surveys (optional)

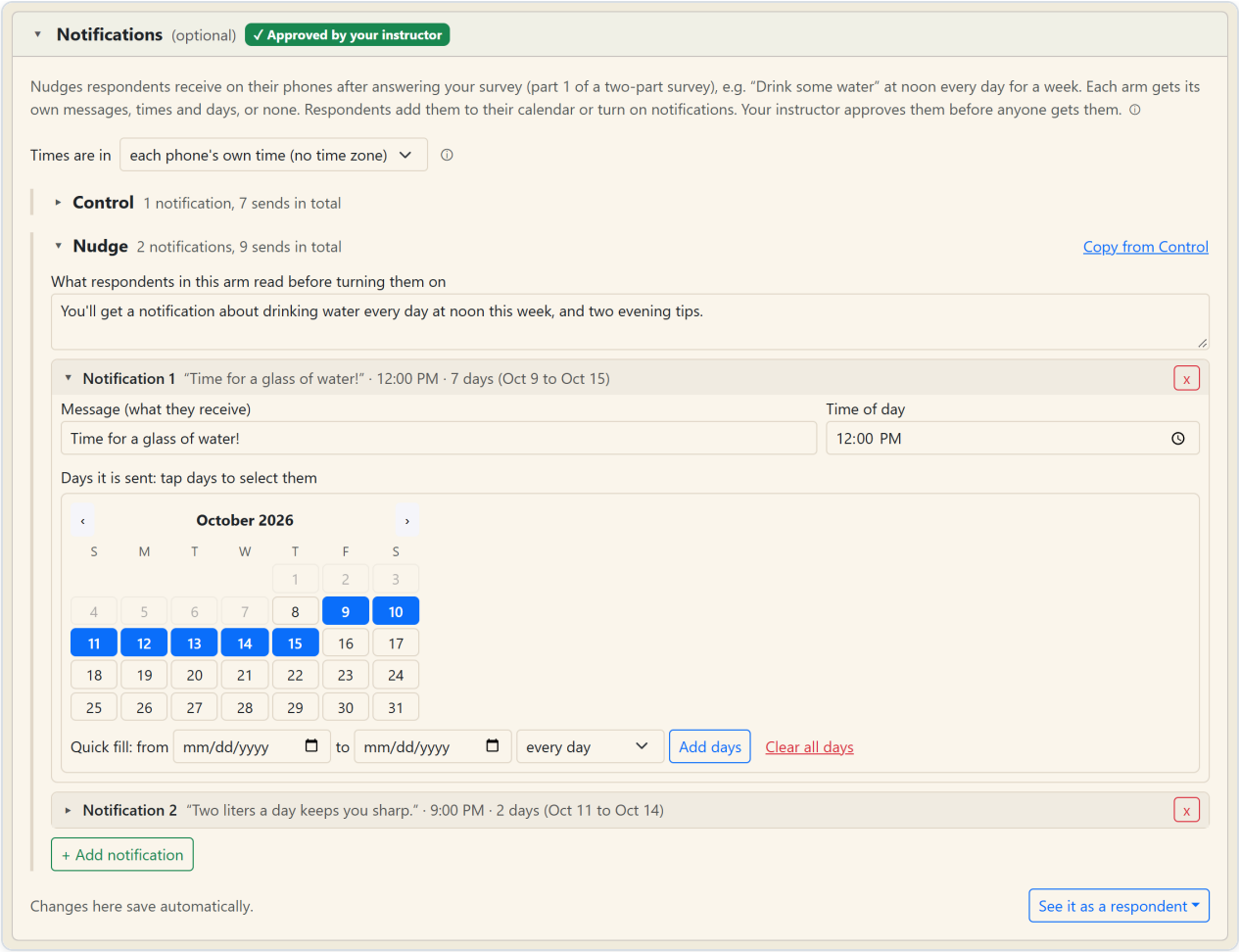
Use this only if you need two rounds of answers from the same classmates, for example a baseline and then an outcome after a week of notifications. Open the **Two-part survey** card under your questions and turn on **This survey has two parts**.




- **Part 2 starts at**: the questions before it are part 1. A dashed line marks the break on the page.
- For **each part**, choose when it's answered: **in class, during the live session** (when you present; the default for part 1), **in class, launched separately by your instructor** (for example at the start of class), or **remote**: classmates answer from their lobby, on their own time, between the dates you choose. Both parts can't be in the live session, since they'd follow each other right away.
- **Part 2 is only for classmates who answered part 1**, and they stay in the same arm.
- A part-2 question can't be a follow-up to a part-1 answer, and `{{Qn}}` doesn't work across parts.
- Your instructor approves remote dates before they open. Changing them later needs approval again.

## 7. Notifications (optional)

Notifications (nudges) are messages respondents get on their phones after answering your survey (part 1 of a two-part survey), for example "Time for a glass of water!" every day at noon for a week. They work with one-part surveys too. Each arm gets its own, or none.




- **What respondents read before turning them on**, per arm: e.g. "You'll get a notification about drinking water every day at noon this week."
- **+ Add notification** for each message, with its own **time of day** and **days**: tap days on the calendar, or use **Quick fill** (every day, every 2 or 3 days, every week, or weekdays only, between two dates). Add several to send a different message in week 2, or the same message at different times.
- **Times are in** each phone's own time by default (noon is noon wherever the respondent is), or in a time zone you pick.
- Respondents choose how to get them: their calendar, or notifications from the site. Your instructor approves them before anyone gets them.

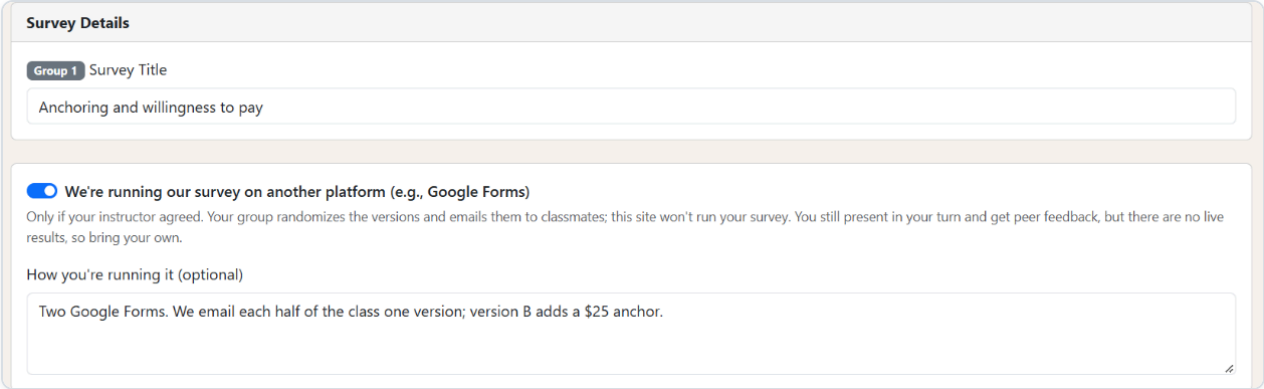
> **A placebo helps.** If only your treatment arm gets notifications, only that arm goes through the "add them" step, so the arms differ in more than the message. Consider a neutral message for the control arm on the same days.

## 8. Running your survey on another platform

With your instructor's permission, your group can run its survey somewhere else, such as Google Forms. In that case **your group** randomizes the versions and emails them to classmates; this site won't run your

survey.

1. Create your group as usual (so the group and its members are registered), and give the survey a title.
2. Turn on **We're running our survey on another platform**. The arms and questions disappear and are no longer required.
3. Optionally, describe how you're running it. Classmates see this note when they give you feedback.

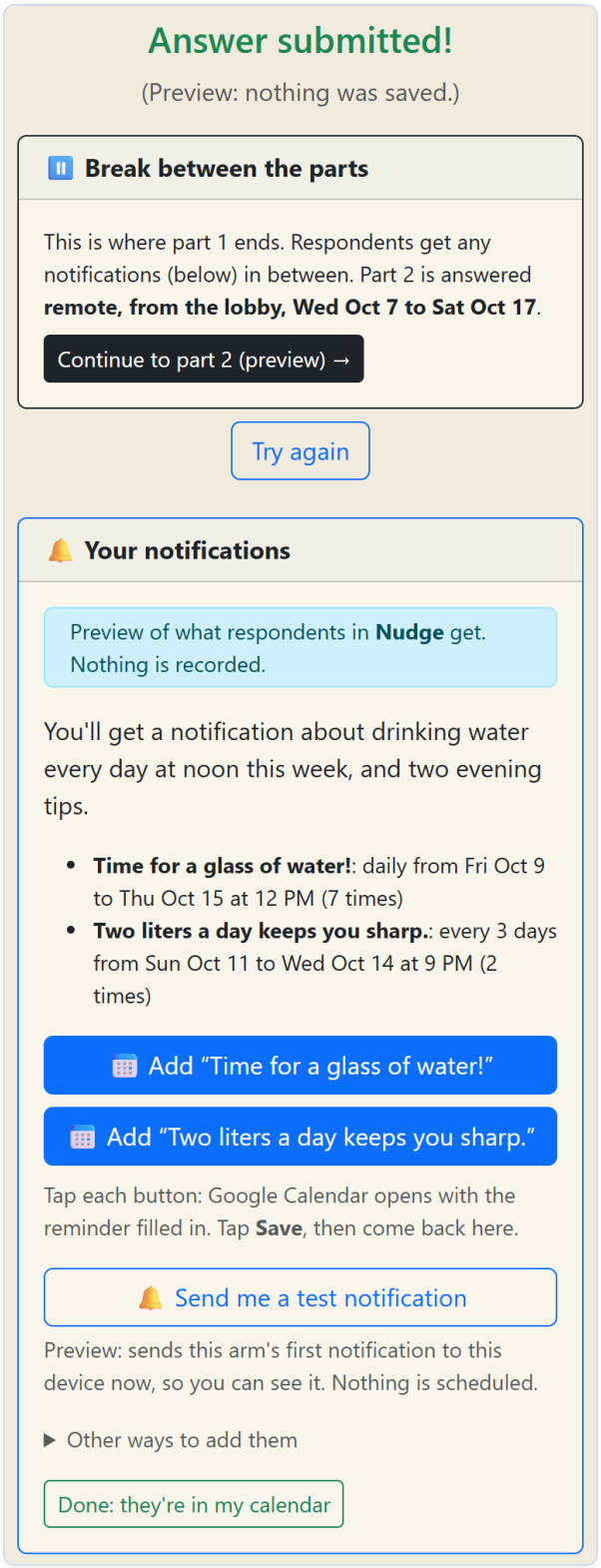



You keep your group number, present in your turn and get peer feedback like every other group. There are no live results in class, so bring your own. Anything you'd already built here is kept: turning the switch off brings it back.

## 9. Previewing before class

Check your survey from both sides before it's locked. Nothing you do in a preview is saved.

1 **Preview survey** (top of the survey page) shows exactly what a respondent sees on their phone, for the arm (and part) you pick. Switch arms with the buttons at the top. After part 1 of a two-part survey, a **Break between the parts** card shows how part 2 runs, the notifications that arm gets (with **Send me a test notification**, to see one on your own phone), and **Continue to part 2**.



**Preview**: this is what a respondent in **High anchor** sees. Answers are not saved. Control | High anchor

Group 1

## Anchoring and willingness to pay

Question 1 of 2

### Question 1: Willingness to pay

Most students pay $25 for a university coffee mug. How much would you pay (in dollars)?

Enter a number

Previous Next

2 **Preview dashboard** shows the charts and tables that will be projected in class, filled with made-up responses. Change the sample size, or click **New random sample** to see how results vary. **Download example answers** gives the same made-up answers in the format of your real data, so you can prepare your analysis before class.

**Dashboard preview** with **40** made-up respondents, so you can see how your results will look in class. These are random sample answers, not real data, and nothing is saved.

Sample size 40 Apply

The example file has the same made-up answers as the charts below, in exactly the format of your real download: one row per respondent, one column per question, plus time and timer columns.

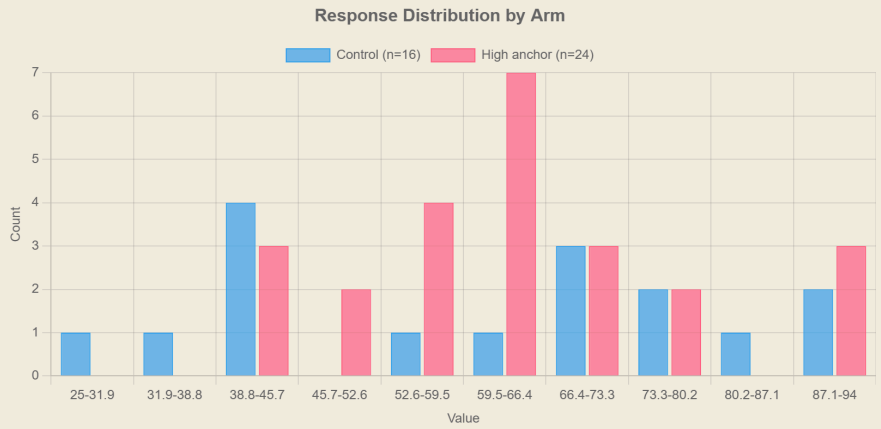
⇩ Download example answers (CSV) New random sample

## Anchoring and willingness to pay

Group #1

**40 responses / 40 students**

Q1: Willingness to pay | Q2: Would buy | Q3: Reason




| Arm | N | Mean | Median | Std Dev | Min | Max |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Control** | 16 | 62 | 70 | 19.61 | 25 | 89 |
| **High anchor** | 24 | 63.5 | 64 | 15.07 | 39 | 94 |

### Questions by Arm Hide

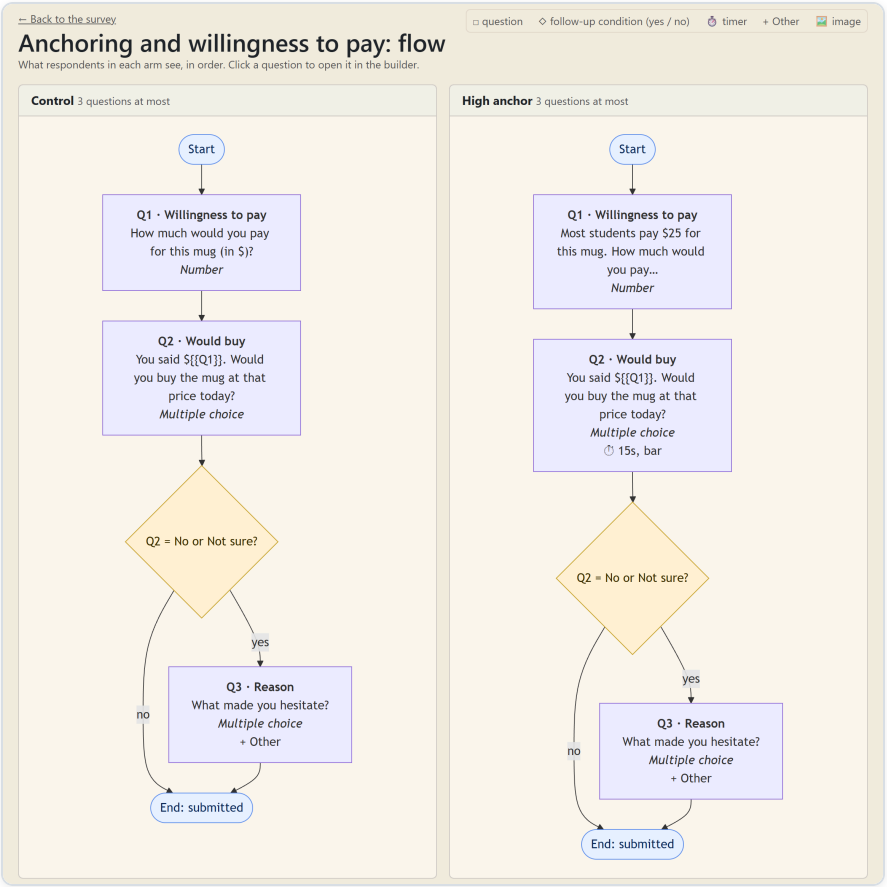
**Control**

**Q1 (Willingness to pay):** How much would you pay for this mug (in $)?
**Q2 (Would buy):** You said ${{Q1}}. Would you buy the mug at that price today?
**Q3 (Reason):** What made you hesitate?

**High anchor**

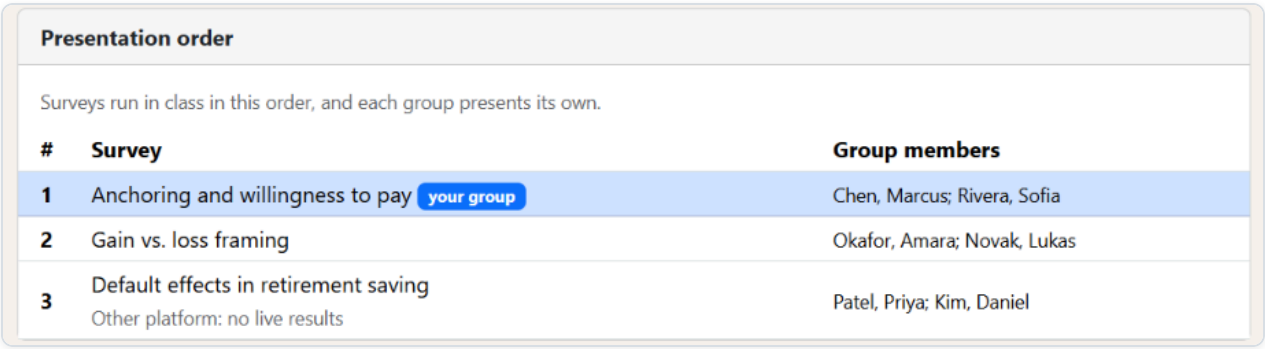
**Q1 (Willingness to pay):** Most students pay $25 for this mug. How much would you pay (in $)?
**Q2 (Would buy):** You said ${{Q1}}. Would you buy the mug at that price today?
**Q3 (Reason):** What made you hesitate?

3 **View as flow chart** draws each arm's path through your survey: the questions it sees, follow-ups (yes/no), timers, and the break between parts. Click a question to jump to it.




## 10. Presentation order

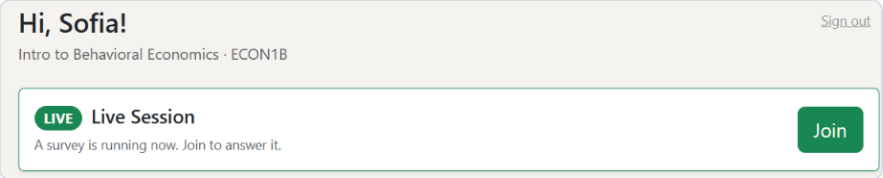
Your instructor sets the presentation order; group numbers are just labels. When your instructor shows the order, your lobby lists every group's survey in the order they run in class, next to your comments, with each group's members. Your group and the groups you comment on are highlighted, so you know when you present and which presentations to watch closely. Groups running their survey on another platform are marked **Other platform: no live results**; they still present in their turn.



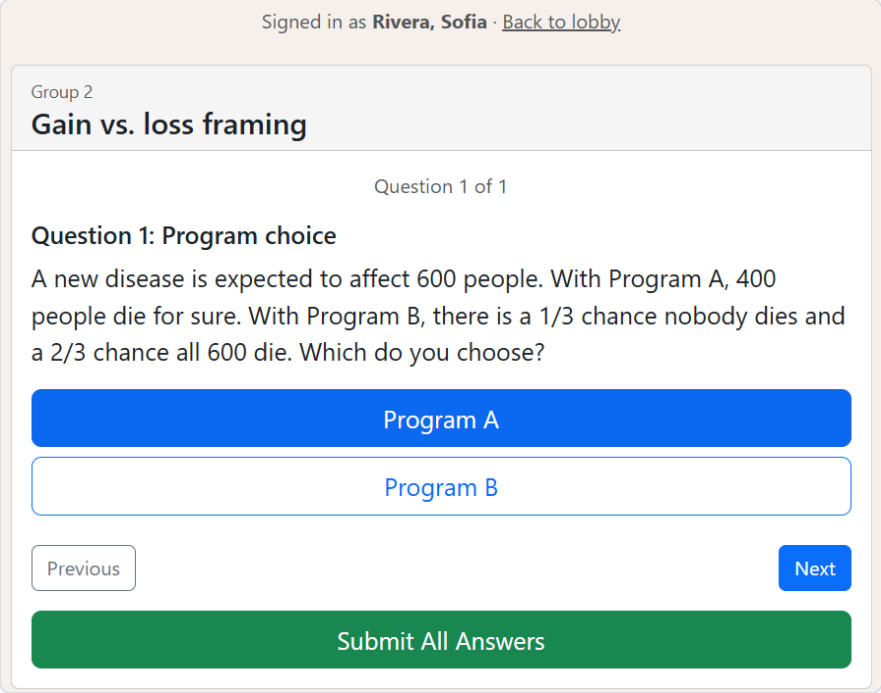
## 11. Class day

Bring a charged phone or laptop. Sign in before class starts so you're ready.

1. In your lobby, click **Join** on the Live Session card. You'll see "Waiting for the next survey".

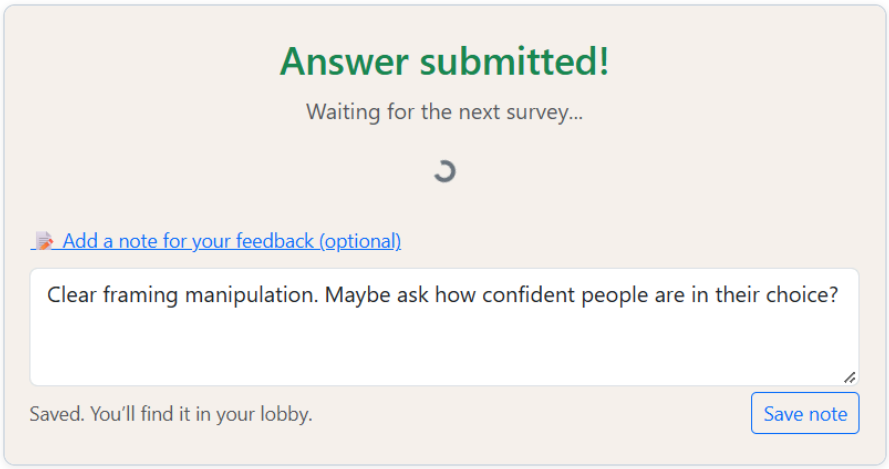



2. When the instructor starts a group's survey, it appears on your screen within a few seconds. Answer and click **Submit All Answers**.



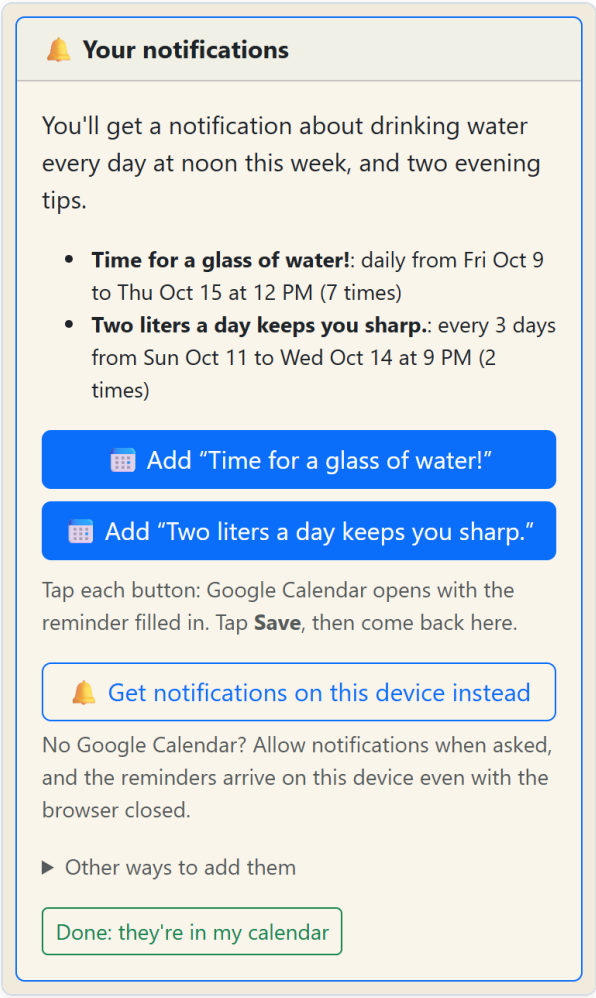

3. Wait for the next one. Keep the page open; there's no need to refresh.

**Notes for feedback.** After you submit, a small link appears: **Add a note for your feedback (optional)**. Jot down your thoughts while they're fresh. Only you can see the note, and it becomes your draft comment for that group.

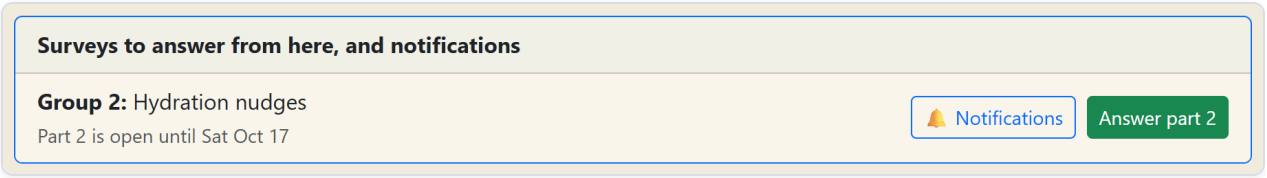



> **Your own group's survey:** you may see "You designed this survey" instead of the questions; designers usually don't answer their own experiment. If you see "Your answer was not saved", tap **Submit** again.

**Notifications after answering.** If the group set up notifications, a **Your notifications** box appears after you submit. On an iPhone, tap **Add to my calendar**, then **Add All**. On Android, tap each **Add** button and then **Save** in Google Calendar, or tap **Get notifications on this device instead** and allow notifications. On a computer, download the calendar file. You can add them later from your lobby too.



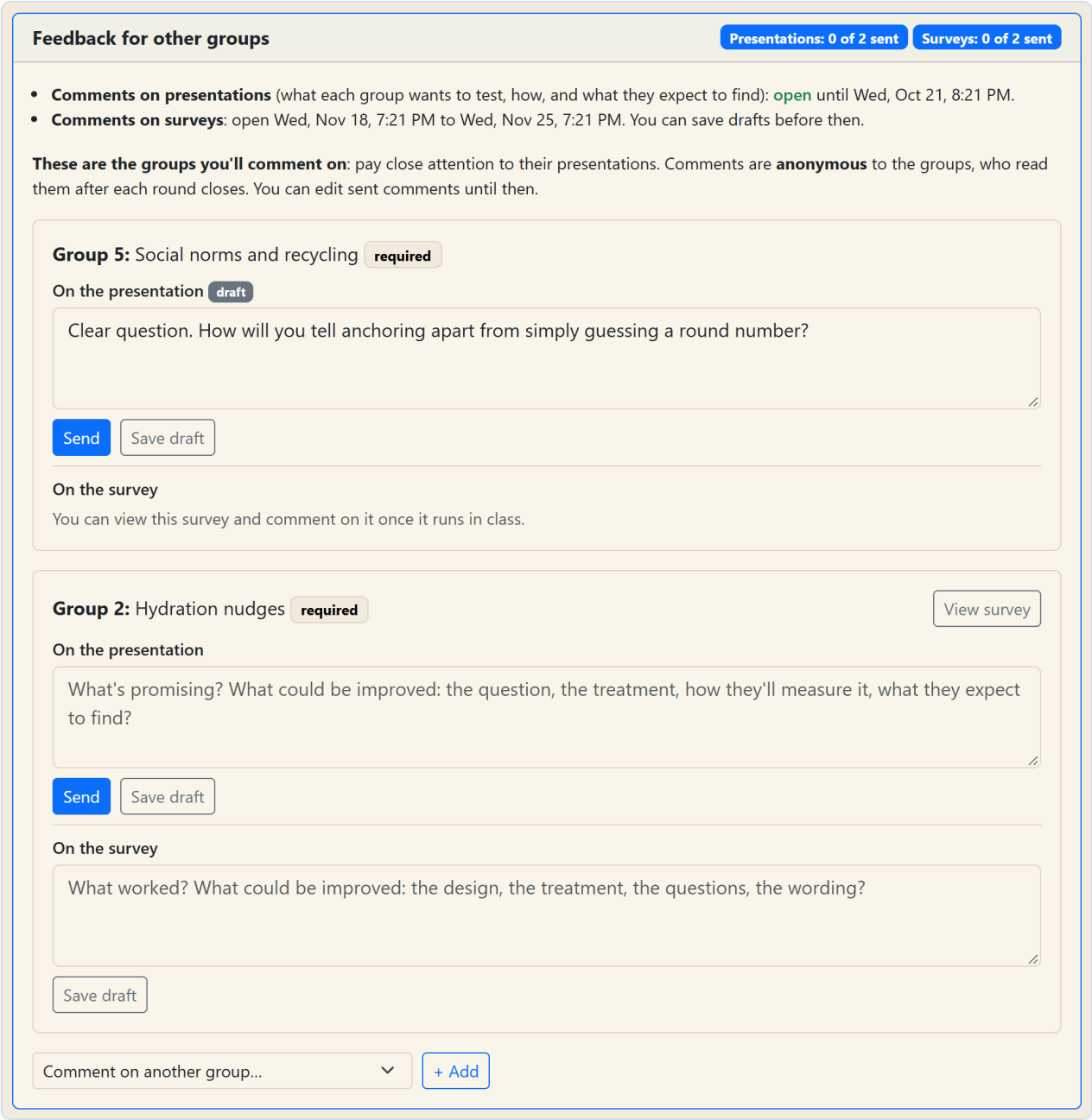

**Parts answered on your own time.** Remote parts of two-part surveys appear in your lobby with **Answer part 1** or **Answer part 2** while they're open. Part 2 only appears if you answered part 1.




## 12. Peer feedback

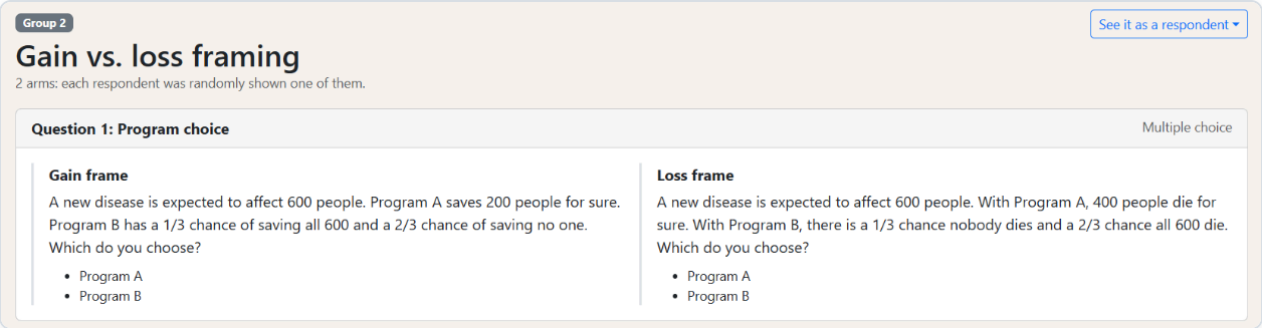
Part of your grade is commenting on other groups' experiments: at least the groups you're assigned, marked **required**. Groups are assigned at random so every group gets about the same number of reviewers, and never your own. Your instructor can run two rounds, with the **same assigned groups** in both:

- **Comments on presentations**: on each group's experiment sketch (what they want to test, how, and what they expect to find), before the surveys run. You comment without seeing their survey: it stays hidden until it runs, so nobody sees the treatment before answering.
- **Comments on surveys**: on each group's survey, once it has run in class (or early). Then **View survey** shows all its arms side by side.




- The top of the card says when each round opens and closes (in your time zone). Your assigned groups appear as soon as your instructor assigns them.
- Each group has one box per round. **Save draft** is private and works before a round opens; notes you took after answering a survey in class appear as drafts in the survey round.
- **Send** works while a round is open. You can keep editing a sent comment until that round closes.
- **Comment on another group** adds extra comments; you can remove extras, but not required ones.

- The counters ("Presentations: 1 of 2 sent") show your progress in each round.

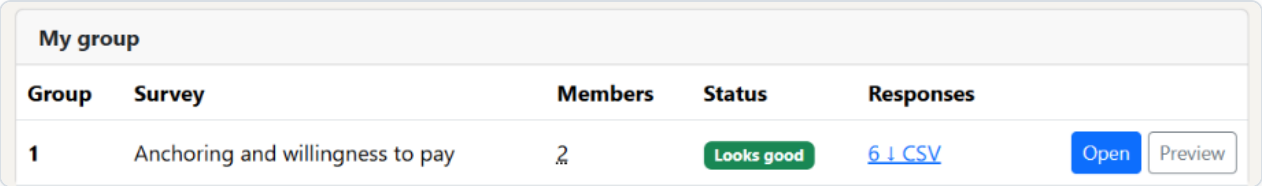



Comments are **anonymous** to the groups: they see "Reviewer 1, Reviewer 2", while your instructor sees names for grading. Groups read each round's comments once that round closes, in their lobby. Good comments are specific: what works, and one concrete change to the design, wording or treatment.

---

## 13. Downloading your data

After your survey runs, download its responses from your lobby (the number in the **Responses** column) or from the bottom of the survey page. Downloads keep working after surveys are locked.




The file is a CSV that opens in Excel, Google Sheets, R or Stata. **Wide** (the default) has one row per respondent and one column per question, plus time on each question, whether they left the page, and timeouts:

```
respondent_id,arm,Q1 Willingness to pay (numeric),...
R-7KQ2PX,Control,8,...
R-M4TW9A,High anchor,20,...
```

**Long** has one row per respondent and question (respondent, arm, part, question, answer, seconds...), handy for regressions with question or part effects. Two-part surveys mark part-2 questions, and surveys with notifications add whether each respondent added them (calendar file, Google Calendar links, notifications turned on, delivered and tapped).

The newer types add columns to the wide file, ready for analysis: **ranking**, one "rank of *item*" column per item; **rating grid**, one column per statement; **budget split**, one column per item; **price list** and **lottery**, the number of A choices, the row where the respondent switched to B, and how many times they switched. Shuffled questions add the order each respondent saw, attention checks add "passed check" columns, and a shuffled question order adds each question's position.

Respondents appear only as random IDs, never by name. Compare the answers across arms: that difference is your treatment effect. The **Survey Config** download lists what each arm showed. Groups that ran their survey on another platform collect their own data there.

---

## 14. Troubleshooting

| Problem | What to do |
|---|---|
| Forgot your password | Ask your instructor to reset it. Then sign in with your ID and choose a new one. |
| "ID not found" | Check the ID. If it's right, email your instructor to be added to the roster. |
| It says "Welcome back" and asks for a password, but you never signed in | Email your instructor right away; they'll reset it. |
| Can't edit your survey | Surveys are locked (lock notice at the top), or your group submitted it early. Ask your instructor. |
| "Saving deletes responses" warning | Your survey already has answers. Download them before changing anything. |
| Survey doesn't appear in class | Wait a few seconds; the page checks every 3 seconds. If it still doesn't show, go back to the lobby and click **Join** again. |
| Can't accept an invite | The group is full, or you're already in a group. Leave your current group first, or ask the inviter to check. |
| "Waiting for your instructor's approval" | Notifications and remote dates need your instructor's approval. Nothing is sent, and remote parts stay closed, until then. |
| A `{{Q1}}` shows up as text | That question wasn't answered before this one (a skipped follow-up, or a different part). See section 5. |
| Notifications don't arrive | Check that notifications are allowed for the site in your browser settings, or use the calendar instead. On iPhone, use the calendar. |
| Part 2 isn't in your lobby | It only appears for classmates who answered part 1, between its dates. |